

CAPITAL EFFICIENCY THESIS

Why \$12M. Not \$172M.

A decision intelligence OS built agentic — not retrofitted.
The math that makes 95% margins possible from day one.



Competitors proved the category. They also showed how not to build it.

AERA TECHNOLOGY

\$172M

Raised to retrofit AI onto legacy ERP workflows. On-prem integrations. Enterprise sales cycle 12-18 months.

Category: Decision Automation

QUANTEXA

\$546M

Financial crime graph intelligence. Custom data science teams per deployment. Regulatory compliance overhead.

Category: Network Intelligence

PEAK AI

\$209M

Decision intelligence for retail. Heavy professional services. Implementation-led revenue model.

Category: Retail DI

Combined raised: **\$927M** — Market validation is real. The spend model is not.

Their cost wasn't engineering. It was architecture debt + GTM friction.

01 Legacy Retrofitting

Adding AI to systems built for a pre-AI world. Every integration requires custom glue code.

02 Team-Heavy Development

50-200 engineers before product-market fit. Payroll dominates the burn rate.

03 12-18 Month Sales Cycles

Enterprise procurement + IT procurement + security review. Revenue arrives slow, CAC balloons.

INTIVO'S DIFFERENCE

Born agentic. No legacy to fix.

- CTO-led build using AI tools
- Phase 1 build cost: **\$100-\$200 total**
- 30-day implementation vs 18 months
- AI-native stack, not AI-bolted

The \$12M is not for building. It is for reaching customers.

Four systems that keep cost predictable at scale.

A

Decision Budget Limits

Each customer gets a hard monthly limit: Basic 50, Growth 200, Pro 500 decisions. AI cannot exceed budget without upgrade.

Prevents cost explosion

B

Signal Filtering Layer

Only anomalies, revenue drops, churn risks, and payment failures reach AI. Rules-based pre-filter handles the rest.

Reduces AI load 60–90%

C

AI Routing Levels

Level 1 cheap (labels), Level 2 medium (trends), Level 3 expensive (RCA). Most signals never reach deep AI.

Cost per decision controlled

D

Memory Reuse System

Similar past decisions are retrieved from embeddings and reused. Repeated AI calls are skipped entirely.

Saves 30–50% AI cost at scale

Five phases. Milestone-gated spend.

PHASE 1

0-20

customers

Validate full loop. CTO-led build. AI tools only.

\$100-\$200

build cost

\$30-\$120/mo

run cost

\$0.7-\$1.7/user

PHASE 2

20-50

customers

Improve RCA. Refine decisions. Stabilize UX.

\$300-\$600

build cost

\$70-\$200/mo

run cost

\$1-\$2.5/user

PHASE 3

100-300

customers

First real SaaS scaling. Multi-tenant. 2 engineers added.

\$5K-\$11K

eng. overhead

\$2.3K-\$5.7K/mo

run cost

\$1.5-\$3/user

PHASE 4

300-500

customers

Reliability + workflow automation. DevOps structure.

\$12K-\$27K

eng. overhead

\$4.8K-\$13K/mo

run cost

\$1.2-\$2.8/user

PHASE 5

500+

customers

Enterprise readiness. Prediction engine. DI maturity.

\$38K-\$95K

eng. overhead

\$13K-\$37K/mo

run cost

\$0.8-\$2.5/user at scale

Selling decisions, not AI usage.

Margins widen as the system learns.

BASIC

\$49

/month

50 decisions
10K events

60-75%
margin

GROWTH

\$99

/month

200 decisions
50K events

70%
margin

PRO

\$199

/month

500 decisions
200K events

75-85%
margin

ENTERPRISE

\$500-
\$2K

/month

Custom limits
SLA +
governance

High
margin if
controlled

WHY THIS WORKS

We sell outcomes – not compute.

- Decision budget = hard usage cap. Margins are protected.
- Memory reuse means revenue grows faster than costs.
- Signal filtering cuts AI spend 60-90% per customer.
- Efficiency improves with scale – cost/user falls in Phase 5.

COST PER
CUSTOMER/MO
\$10-\$30

PHASE 1
PRICING
\$49-\$99

GROSS
MARGIN
85%+

The \$12M Seed funds the journey to 100 customers.

After that, the product may fund itself.

NOW — PHASE 1 TO 3

Seed Round

\$12M

0 → 100 **~\$180K**

customers ARR at exit

- Market thesis + architecture efficiency
- GTM hiring: 3–5 sales reps (\$15–\$25K/mo)
- Tech spend: under \$12K/mo total (Phase 3)

PHASE 3 COMPLETE — OPTIONAL

Series A

\$3M–\$5M

100 → 500 **~\$900K**

customers ARR potential

- 100 customers at \$149 avg = \$180K ARR covers tech
- Capital needed only for GTM acceleration
- Lean model: not \$8–\$20M — just enough to hire sales

PHASE 5 — IF NEEDED

Series B

\$10M–\$15M

500+ **\$900K+**

customers ARR — may self-fund

- 500 customers x \$149 avg = \$894K ARR/yr
- Monthly run: \$13–\$37K. Margins positive.
- Raise only for global expansion or enterprise push

Total tech bill across all 5 phases:
<\$1K to build. ~\$133K to scale. 98% of the \$12M buys customers.

PHASE	ENG. COST	MONTHLY RUN	COST/USER
Phase 1 — 0 to 20 customers	\$100-\$200	\$30-\$120	\$0.7-\$1.7
Phase 2 — 20 to 50 customers	\$300-\$600	\$70-\$200	\$1-\$2.5
Phase 3 — 100 to 300 customers	\$5K-\$11K	\$2.3K-\$5.7K	\$1.5-\$3
Phase 4 — 300 to 500 customers	\$12K-\$27K	\$4.8K-\$13K	\$1.2-\$2.8
Phase 5 — 500+ customers	\$38K-\$95K	\$13K-\$37K	\$0.8-\$2.5

3-YEAR TECH SPEND ESTIMATE

~\$211K

Engineering overhead + run costs combined across all 5 phases. True AI build (Phases 1-2) is under \$1K — the rest is headcount and infrastructure for scaling.

OF THE \$12M SEED

~1.8%

goes to engineering and infrastructure. The remaining 98.2% is commercial: GTM, customer acquisition, and success.

THE JUSTIFICATION

\$12M when build costs \$135K.
The gap is entirely customer acquisition.

WHERE THE \$12M ACTUALLY GOES

GTM & Sales Sales team, demand gen, events, partnerships, outbound	\$5.4M – 45%
Customer Success Onboarding, retention, expansion revenue, 30-day implementation	\$3.6M – 30%
Product & Engineering Phase 3–4 team scaling, multi-tenant build, AI upgrades	\$1.8M – 15%
Operations & Reserve Legal, compliance, infrastructure, 6-month runway buffer	\$1.2M – 10%

COMPETITIVE COMPARISON

Aera Technology – \$172M 60% tech & retrofitting 40% GTM & sales Expensive on both sides. No architecture efficiency.
Intivo – \$12M ~2% tech (\$211K est.) ~98% GTM & commercial Technology is solved. Capital accelerates customers.
The \$12M buys 100 customers at a cost per customer acquisition that pencils at Series A. At \$99–\$199/month avg, 100 customers = \$120K–\$240K ARR

THE ASK

\$12M

Seed Round

Target: 100 customers by Phase 3. Path to Series A at Phase 4.

PROOF POINTS

\$135K

total engineering
across all 5 phases

95%+

gross margin
from day one

30 days

implementation
vs 18 months

USE OF FUNDS

45%

GTM & Customer Acquisition

Sales team, demand generation, outbound, partnerships, industry presence.

\$5.4M

30%

Customer Success & Onboarding

Fast implementation, retention programs, expansion revenue. 30-day time-to-value.

\$3.6M

15%

Product & Engineering

Phase 3–4 team scaling. Multi-tenant architecture. AI system upgrades.

\$1.8M

10%

Operations & Reserve

Legal, compliance, infrastructure, 6-month operational runway

\$1.2M